

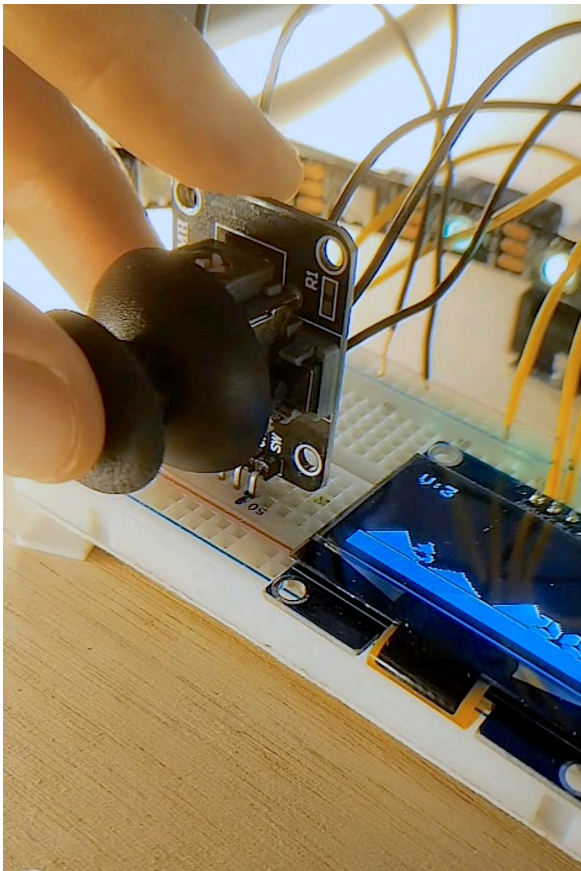
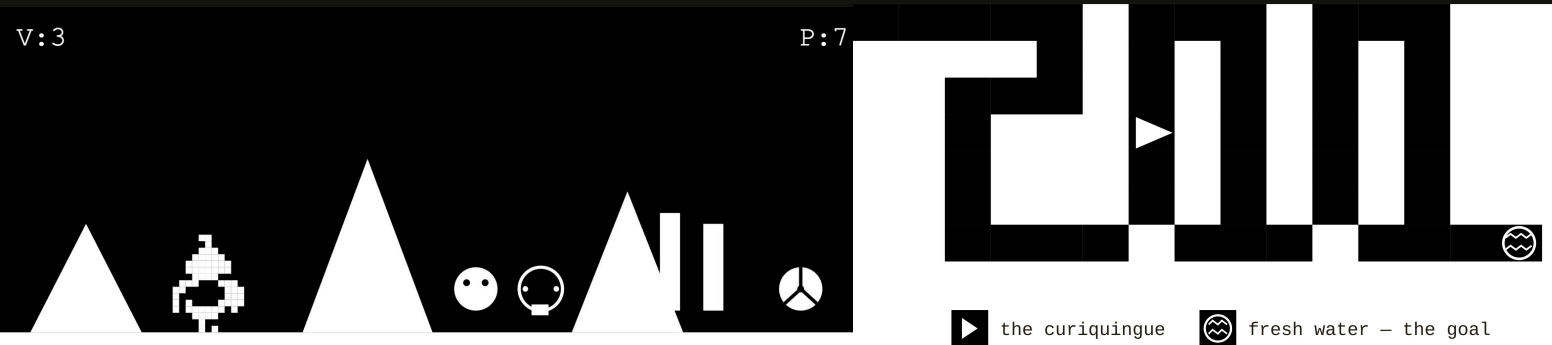
Death is not Game Over: The Curiquingue Tamagotchi Circuit

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KAY PACHA — THE CURIQUINGUE DESCENDS TO THE CITY

UKU PACHA — THE CURIQUINGUE FINDS FRESH WATER



:: ABOUT ::

The Curiquingue Tamagotchi Circuit is a hand-built Arduino arcade where a pixel-art Andean raptor tries to survive the increasingly polluted Chibunga River, flowing down from Chimborazo's glaciers. In Kichwa tradition, its rivers and springs are inhabited by elemental beings that cannot exist where water is contaminated — in strictly scientific terms, contaminated water cannot sustain life. The curiquingue, understood in Andean tradition as a messenger between earth and sky, becomes here a real indicator of environmental health, surpassing its folkloric value.

It descends from its páramo home to dance in Riobamba's Pase del Niño, carrying that same journey into the river below. Struck too many times, it passes from Kay Pacha into Uku Pacha, the world of ancestors and germination, searching a maze for clean water. Finding it lifts it into Hanan Pacha — whole again, its light falling back to the mountain as rain.

:: HOW IT WORKS ::

A Prince of Persia-style precision game: joystick X moves the curiquingue, up jumps, gravity pulls it back. Hazards spawn the farther it travels. Alongside the screen, a 22-LED NeoPixel strip lights the whole run — a quiet gradient of color that tracks the pollution rising with every step. At collapse, the view cuts to Uku Pacha's aerial maze, where the bird — now a small solid shape seen from above — searches for clean water.

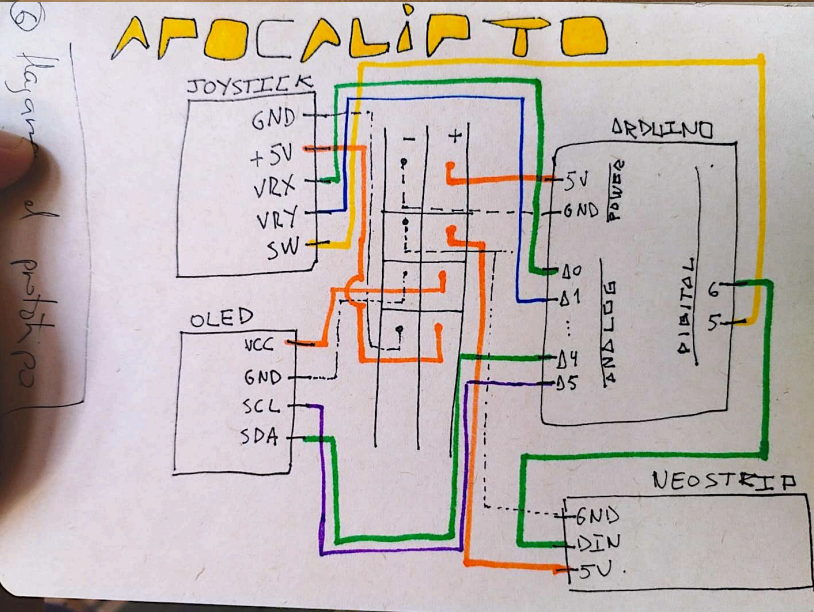
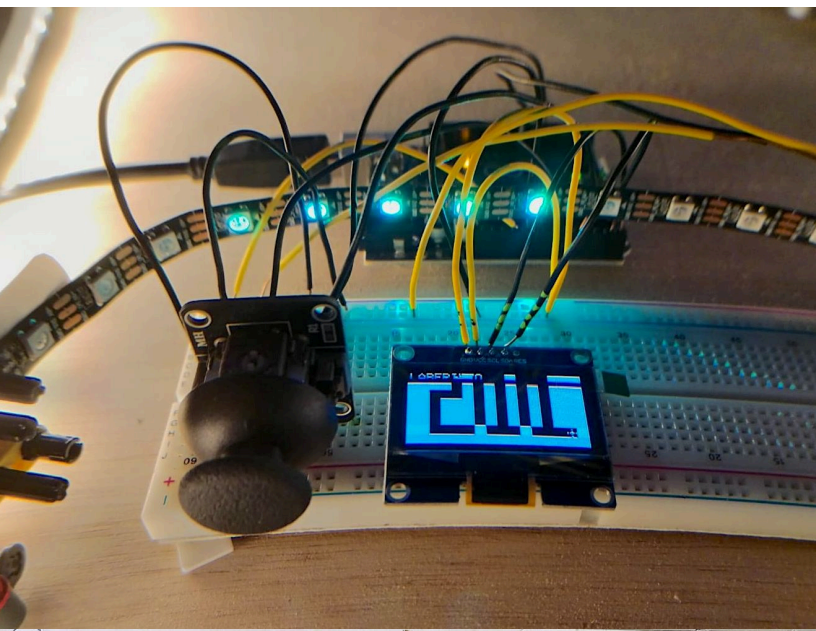
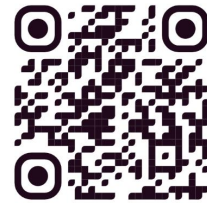
Finding it triggers the ascent: the NeoPixel strip whites out in an accelerating strobe, then resolves into solarpunk gold and green — the same lights, now telling a different part of the story. The chassis is hand-soldered, modeled on Riobamba's coin-fed arcade machines.



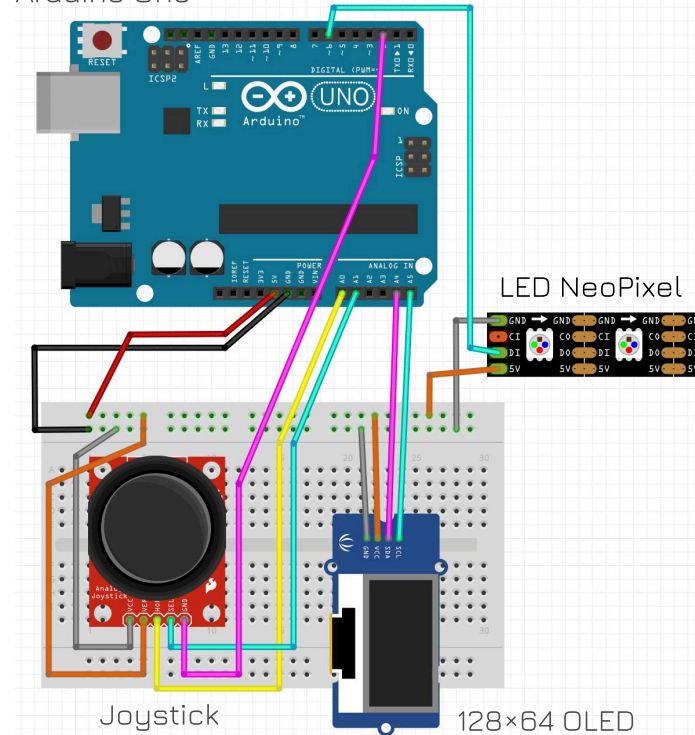
:: PROJECT STATUS ::

This circuit, developed during the Apocalypse Technologies program, has reached its Minimum Viable Product stage — proven, and ready to grow into a fully playable arcade game by migrating from the Arduino Uno to an ESP32 with a color TFT screen.

The QR code here links to GitHub, where an assembly manual — written as a complete, replicable guide to the playable demo version — offers an entry point for technology-agnostic readers interested in physical computing, citizen science, and Andean cosmovision alike.



Arduino Uno



Joystick

128x64 OLED

SOUTH AMERICA - ECUADOR

1. Splash — "Curiquingue Tamagotchi" fades in, line by line.
2. Instructions.
3. Kay Pacha, intro — the curiquingue walks in place.
4. Kay Pacha, the descent — "Descending 3000 m.a.s.l., from the Chimborazo volcano basin, down into the Riobamba valley, to dance at the Pase del Niño." Hazards begin; three hits, or the full distance survived, trigger the threshold.
5. Uku Pacha — a red strobe entry, then the maze, centered on screen, in search of the pogyo (Kichwa for water spring).
6. Hanan Pacha, ascend — the curiquingue rises, whole again.
7. Hanan Pacha, the Andean glyph rain — chakana, spiral, inti, and the rest fall before the cycle turns over.
8. "Death is not game over" — held, then the loop returns to step 3.



Location within Ecuador